

SAT Reading & Writing

Transitions 3

Question #	ID		Answer
3.1	e3edc138	In a heated debate in biogeography, the field is divided between dispersalists and vicariancists. _____ there are those who argue that dispersal is the most crucial determining factor in a species' distribution, and those who insist that vicariance (separation due to geographic barriers) is. Biogeographer Isabel Sanmartín counts herself among neither. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Furthermore, B. By contrast, C. Similarly, D. That is,	D
3.2	00221c00	In 1815, while in exile in Jamaica, Venezuelan revolutionary Simón Bolívar penned a letter praising England's republican government and expressing hope that Latin American nations seeking independence from Spain might achieve something similar. The letter was addressed to a local merchant, Henry Cullen; _____ though, Bolívar's goal was to persuade political leaders from England and Europe to support his cause. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. additionally, B. ultimately, C. accordingly, D. consequently,	B
3.3	8e9677e6	In 2009, the Craft and Folk Art Museum in Los Angeles hosted a special exhibition, <i>Sueños/Yume</i>, showcasing the works of local sculptor Dora de Larios. As suggested by the show's title (<i>sueños</i> and <i>yume</i> mean "dreams" in Spanish and Japanese, respectively), de Larios's art reflects a mix of cultural influences. _____ her work is grounded in the artistic traditions of both Mexico and Japan. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In addition, B. In contrast, C. Specifically, D. Therefore,	C
3.4	6e0c60da	When one looks at the dark craggy vistas in Hitoshi Fugo's evocative photo series, one's mind might wander off to the cratered surfaces of faraway planets. _____ it's the series' title, <i>Flying Frying Pan</i>, that brings one back to Earth, reminding the viewer that each photo is actually a close-up view of a familiar household object: a frying pan. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Consequently, B. Alternatively, C. Ultimately, D. Additionally,	C
3.5	2df7b582	Plato believed material objects to be crude representations of unseen ideal forms. In his view, such abstract, nonmaterial forms are the ultimate source of knowledge. Aristotle disagreed, positing that knowledge is best obtained through direct engagement with the material world; _____ sensory experience of the material is the ultimate source of knowledge. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. regardless, B. admittedly, C. in other words, D. meanwhile,	C

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3.6	00e0170f	Magnetic levitation (maglev) trains are suspended above a track by powerful electromagnets, reducing friction and thus allowing for much faster speeds. Though maglev advocates in the US have long imagined these trains crisscrossing the country, their dream remains unrealized. _____ of the handful of maglev trains currently in operation, all are in Asia. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In fact, B. To that end, C. Nevertheless, D. That said,	A
3.7	c071eca2	Iraqi artist Nazik Al-Malaika, celebrated as the first Arabic poet to write in free verse, didn't reject traditional forms entirely; her poem "Elegy for a Woman of No Importance" consists of two ten-line stanzas and a standard number of syllables. Even in this superficially traditional work, _____ Al-Malaika was breaking new ground by memorializing an anonymous woman rather than a famous man. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. therefore, B. in fact, C. moreover, D. though,	D
3.8	176edca6	A 2017 study of sign language learners tested the role of iconicity—the similarity of a sign to the thing it represents—in language acquisition. The study found that the greater the iconicity of a sign, the more likely it was to have been learned. _____ the correlation between acquisition and iconicity was lower than that between acquisition and another factor studied: sign frequency. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In fact, B. In other words, C. Granted, D. As a result,	C
3.9	9f1a0d91	"Tulip mania"—the rapid rise and sudden fall of the price of tulip bulbs in seventeenth-century Amsterdam—is often cited as an example of the perils of rampant market speculation. However, recent research has demonstrated that the episode was neither as frenzied nor as disastrous as has been thought. The popular myth surrounding it, _____ should be regarded with some skepticism. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. for example, B. by contrast, C. nevertheless, D. therefore,	D
3.10	47e238be	Seismologists Kaiqing Yuan and Barbara Romanowicz have proposed that the magma fueling Iceland's more than 30 active volcano systems emerges from deep within Earth. The great depths involved—nearly 3,000 km—mark Iceland's volcanoes as extreme outliers; _____ many of Earth's volcanoes are fed by shallow pockets of magma found less than 15 km below the surface. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. indeed, B. nevertheless, C. in addition, D. consequently,	A

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3.11	ad729337	With its clichéd imagery of suburban lawns and power lines, John Ashbery's 2004 poem "Ignorance of the Law Is No Excuse" may seem barren terrain for critical analysis. _____ cultural critic Lauren Berlant finds fertile ground in just its first two stanzas, devoting most of a book chapter to deciphering the "weight of the default space" Ashbery creates in this poem. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Likewise, B. Nonetheless, C. In turn, D. That is,	B
3.12	ecb31049	The Sun and other stars are powered by nuclear fusion reactions, in which two atoms collide to form a single heavier atom, releasing energy. Scientists have long believed that fusion has the potential to meet humanity's clean energy needs. _____ prior to December 2022, no fusion reaction in a laboratory setting had ever generated a net energy gain. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. For this reason, B. Moreover, C. Specifically, D. That said,	D
3.13	1e31470f	_____ To perform a quad axel, a figure skater must leap into the air and complete four and a half rotations before landing, an extreme feat. _____ in 2022, when 17-year-old Ilia Malinin landed the first quad axel—considered the most difficult quad jump—in a high-level competition, the audience was left awestruck. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Moreover, B. Fittingly, C. Next, D. However,	B
3.14	9dc4e640	_____ The mineral mtorolite is most commonly found in Zimbabwe. Mtorolite is cryptocrystalline, meaning that its crystalline structure is so fine that the individual crystals cannot be distinguished by the naked eye or even under a microscope. The crystals in microcrystalline minerals are also not visible to the naked eye; _____ they can usually be seen under a microscope. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. thus, B. for example, C. that said, D. similarly,	C

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3.15	8112b7e3	Ugandan American professor Peter Nazareth believed that Elvis Presley's music is best understood not as a homogeneous collection but as an anthology (because Elvis showcased the contributions of a wide range of gospel, blues, and rock artists). _____ Nazareth entitled his college course on Elvis and his music, which focused on Elvis's many musical influences, "Elvis as Anthology." Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. To that end, B. In sum, C. That is, D. In addition,	A
3.16	9502ec65	When soil becomes contaminated by toxic metals, it can be removed from the ground and disposed of in a landfill. _____ contaminated soil can be detoxified via phytoremediation: plants that can withstand high concentrations of metals absorb the pollutants and store them in their shoots, which are then cut off and safely disposed of, preserving the health of the plants. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Alternatively, B. Specifically, C. For example, D. As a result,	A
3.17	974b5a8c	The Madison is a type of line dance that involves neat rows of dancers performing a repeated sequence of steps in unison. _____ many other dances are also defined by order, repetition, and synchronicity, but the Madison is distinguished by its extreme uniformity; when an auditorium full of dancers performs the Madison, one almost gets the impression of a military march. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. However, B. Of course, C. Specifically, D. Moreover,	B
3.18	edf30612	In the late twentieth century, scholars directed much discussion toward issues of spatiality. Adherents to quantitative analytical approaches delineated space with the use of GIS spatial technologies; _____ cultural geographer Doreen Massey defined space as the product of "an ever-shifting social geometry of power and signification," focusing instead on socio-political forces. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. for example, B. by contrast, C. as such, D. likewise,	B

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3.19	f5959727	Modernista architects championed nature in their designs. _____ the wavy staircase and ornate floral tilework of Hospital de Sant Pau, a Modernista hospital designed by Lluís Domènech i Montaner, couldn't exactly grow in a forest. Still, one sees natural influences in Domènech i Montaner's penchant for curves (rather than right angles) and plant- and animal-inspired flourishes. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. Furthermore, B. Similarly, C. Of course, D. Thus,	C
3.20	7ce14583	In Asiya Wadud's 2022 poem "Shorn, Treaded Red," the poet contemplates a painting that has inspired her: Etel Adnan's 2020 work <i>Satellites 27</i>. The painting, which features overlapping geometric shapes, fuels the poem's exploration of temporality and identity. _____ in responding to Adnan's artwork, Wadud's poem reflects on the relationship between poetry and other art forms. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition? A. In other words, B. For instance, C. What's more, D. Conversely,	C